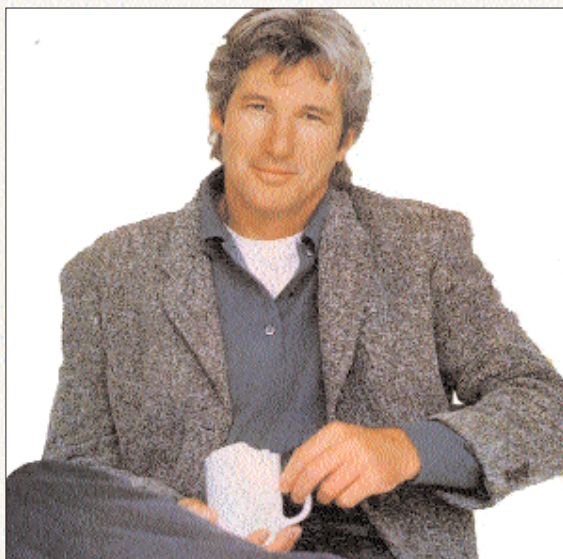


Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Tibet What?

Tibet is Richard Gere's favourite country. The Buddhist actor has a lot to do with the Dalai Lama, Tibetan culture, and all things Tibet: he's a founding member of both Tibet House and The Gere Foundation, which "aims to



alleviate suffering and help to restore autonomy to the people of Tibet." And even as you read this, he's fuming.

So as not to inflame the sentiments of our Chinese readers, we'll make a correction: Tibet is Gere's favourite Autonomous Region.

Mr Gere is fuming because Google Earth, possibly because of pressure from the Chinese government, has taken Tibet off the map. Actually, just the name: a search for "Tibet" returned no results for a journo in the UK. Tibet is very much on the map, replete with the usual black helicopters. And lots and lots of roads. Visit www.theregister.co.uk/2006/08/18/google_tibet for several detailed screenshots.

Until the Gere foundation does something about it, we've got to advise Mr Gere: do a search for "Tibet Autonomous Region" instead. Even if it hurts.

"Death By Blending"

Wikipedia founder Jimmy Wales has by now become a Web celebrity. You'll have noticed that, partly because we've mentioned him at least three times in the recent past.

At the recent Wikimania conference, he had a lot of things to say about his goals in general and Wikipedia in particular. "We're not there yet. We're not as good as Britannica—yet. So in the coming years we're going to see a turn towards quality."

We sure hope so. Does Wales even know what kind of articles make up the famed 1.2 million? There are articles on porn stars, porn genres, and porn movies, all of them quite nearly explicit. Who knows just how many of all those articles on the site belong in an encyclopaedia? We googled "weird wikipedia entries," and here's one from many we found:



"List of films by gory death scene: This is a list of films in which characters die violent and gory deaths, often depicted using special effects."

1. Death from being eaten
 2. Death by bisection or dismemberment (excluding decapitation)
 3. Death by blending
- ... and there are 24 of them.
Yes, Mr Wales. Definitely quality over quantity.

Surfus Uninterruptus

Do these things happen only in America? A man and a woman sitting side by side in a cafe, sharing food and drink without saying a word, and typing on their laptops about the tunes played through a shared iPod?

That, our special correspondent in New York says, is the latest fad: couple-surfing. It's essentially about couples, well, surfing together, and saying things they wouldn't say face to face, such as "Your blog sucks."

"Realising that communicating via typing was far more comfortable, we conducted our date without speaking. We traded headphones back and forth, and typed and ordered beer and wine and more food," writes singer Amanda Palmer on her blog.

"It's difficult to communicate things like images, sounds and URLs through speech," writes one of a pair of couple-surfers on his blog. Because every date, as we know, is incomplete without a good URL. Cliché alert: what is the world coming to?

Of course we know what's next: couples sitting next to each other in bed having cybersex.

3-Easy-Steps to Freebies!

- 1** Log on to www.thinkdigit.com/digitpatron to register.
- 2** Enter this 16-digit code and score points (you will find your code at this place every issue)
- 3** Your points get added every month and can be redeemed for exciting gifts!



When You Want Data Storage
In The Most Compact Fashion,
There Is Only One Name
That Stands Out!



GO RED

The Odyssey Pen Drives are way ahead of its competition. In all parameters: Reliable Data Copy & Retention, High Speed Data Transfer Rate, 100% Data Storage Capacity, all combine to make the Odyssey Pen Drives stand apart from the rest. With user friendly features, it gives you the convenience and ease of carrying and storing data. So, if you want data storage in the most compact fashion... Go Red. Get Upgraded.

Odyssey
Technology for The Digital Age

Available Data Copy & Retention	Speedy Data Transfer Rate	High Speed Data Transfer Rate
Actual Data Storage Capacity	100% Data Storage Capacity	100% Data Storage Capacity
High Speed Data Transfer Rate	100% Data Storage Capacity	100% Data Storage Capacity

BETTER UPGRADED